



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

THE LIGHT OF THE QURAN

A Modern Companion to the Holy Quran Sharif

Volume IV • Juz 6 & 7 • Surah Al-An'am & Surah Al-A'raf

In the Blessed Tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Creation • The Signs of Allah • Prophets of Old • The Heights • The Day of Judgment

Designed for the Younger Generation of Muslims by Syed Yasir Ahmad

RECAP — VOLUMES I, II & III

Volume	Juz	Surahs	Core Teaching
I	1	Al-Fatiha, Al-Baqarah (opening)	Faith, prayer, Adam (AS), Bani Israel, Ayat ul-Kursi
II	2-3	Al-Baqarah (close), Aal-e-Imran	Charity, marriage, Uhud, Isa (AS), unity, Tawakkul
III	4-5	An-Nisa, Al-Ma'idah	Justice, women's rights, inheritance, food laws, Islam completed
IV (this volume)	6-7	Al-An'am, Al-A'raf	Creation, Tawheed proofs, Prophets' stories, the cosmic drama

'Do they not look into the realm of the heavens and the earth and everything that Allah has created?' — Al-A'raf 7:185

SURAH 6 • JUZ 7

سُورَةُ الْأَنْعَامِ
AL-AN'AM — THE CATTLE

The Quran's Greatest Proof of Tawheed • Revealed in One Night • 70,000 Angels Accompanied It

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

- Revelation:** Makki — revealed in Makkah in a single night, near the end of the Makkan period
- Number of Ayat:** 165 Verses
- Unique Feature:** Narrated by scholars that it was revealed all at once — accompanied by 70,000 angels glorifying Allah
- Named After:** Cattle (An'am) — referenced in discussing permissible and prohibited animals, and the polytheists' false attributions
- Core Mission:** To demolish polytheism (Shirk) through intellectual argument — the most rational anti-Shirk Surah in the Quran
- Key Verses:** 6:75-79 (Ibrahim's search for truth), 6:103 (Allah not perceived by eyes), 6:151-153 (The 10 Commandments of Islam)
- Tone:** Predominantly intellectual and philosophical — appeals to reason, observation, and logic

THE ARCHITECTURE OF SURAH AL-AN'AM

Section	Verses	Theme	Key Argument
Tawheed through Creation	1-18	Allah created the heavens, earth, darkness and light	If He created everything — why worship what cannot create?
The Mockery of Prophets	33-55	Every Prophet was mocked — you are not alone	History's pattern: truth is always rejected first, then triumphant
Ibrahim's Search for Truth	75-83	Ibrahim (AS) rejects stars, moon, sun — finds Allah	The greatest intellectual journey in the Quran
The Chain of Prophets	84-90	18 Prophets named in rapid succession	One God sent them all — same message across all ages
Revelation is Real	91-107	The Quran is from Allah — not invented	If it were invented, why does it challenge the best Arab minds?
Signs in Creation	95-99	Seeds, dawn, stars, rain, gardens — all signs	Look at creation — every detail points to one Creator
The 10 Islamic Commandments	151-153	The moral foundation of human civilisation	What Allah has truly made sacred — not the polytheists' customs
Warning to Idol-Worshippers	136-150	Critique of pre-Islamic superstitions	Human-invented religion vs divine revelation

PART 1: IBRAHIM'S SEARCH FOR GOD — THE GREATEST INTELLECTUAL JOURNEY (6:75-79)

This passage — just five verses — one of the most powerful Quranic accounts of reasoning toward belief in Allah. A young man, in a society of idol-worshippers and star-gazers, uses pure reason to arrive at the One True God. It is the Quran's gift to every thinking person who has ever asked: 'How do I KNOW there is a God?'

فَلَمَّا جَنَّ عَلَيْهِ اللَّيْلُ رَأَى كَوْكَبًا قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي فَلَمَّا أَفَلَ قَالَ لَا أُحِبُّ الْآفِلِينَ

"When the night grew dark over him, he saw a star and said: 'This is my Lord!' But when it set, he said: 'I do not love things that set.'" 6:76

فَلَمَّا رَأَى الْقَمَرَ بَازِعًا قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي فَلَمَّا أَفَلَ قَالَ لَئِنْ لَمْ يَهْدِنِي رَبِّي لَأَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ الضَّالِّينَ

"Then when he saw the moon rising, he said: 'This is my Lord!' But when it set, he said: 'If my Lord does not guide me, I will surely be among the lost.'" 6:77

فَلَمَّا رَأَى الشَّمْسَ بَازِعَةً قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي هَذَا أَكْبَرُ فَلَمَّا أَفَلَتْ قَالَ يُقَوْمِ إِنِّي بَرِيءٌ مِّمَّا تُشْرِكُونَ

"Then when he saw the sun rising, he said: 'This is my Lord — this is greatest!' But when it set, he said: 'O my people! I am free of what you associate with Allah.'" 6:78

Stage	Object	Ibrahim's Observation	Philosophical Conclusion
Stage 1	A bright star	Beautiful, bright — could this be God?	It SET. A god cannot depend on the night. A god cannot disappear.
Stage 2	The moon	Larger, more majestic — surely this?	It too SET. Same flaw. Dependency = not divine.
Stage 3	The sun	Greatest of all — this must be God!	It also SET. The pattern is clear: everything in creation is finite.
Final Conclusion	None of creation	'I turn my face to the One who created the heavens and the earth'	The Creator cannot be part of creation. Allah is beyond all of it.

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Cosmological Argument — Ibrahim (AS) Preceded Aristotle by Centuries

What Ibrahim (AS) demonstrates in these five verses is what Western philosophy calls the 'Cosmological Argument' — the argument from contingency. Everything we observe in the universe is contingent: it depends on something else, it begins and ends, it changes. A truly necessary being — God — cannot be contingent. Ibrahim (AS) arrived at this through direct observation of the night sky, centuries before Greek philosophers like Aristotle formalised similar arguments. The Quran did not merely affirm God's existence — one of the earliest and most profound scriptural presentations of reasoning about the Creator through a Prophet's own intellectual journey.

MIRACLE: The Argument from Cosmic Fine-Tuning

Modern physics has discovered what scientists call the 'Fine-Tuning Problem': the fundamental constants of the universe — the gravitational constant, the strong nuclear force, the speed of light, the cosmological constant — are calibrated to mind-bending precision. If the gravitational constant were different by 1 part in 10 to the power of 60, stars could not form. If the strong nuclear force varied by 2%, atoms could not exist. Physicist Roger Penrose calculated the probability of the Big Bang producing a life-permitting universe by chance as 1 in $10^{(10^{123})}$ — a number so large it has no analogy. Ibrahim (AS)'s conclusion — 'I turn to the One who created the heavens and the earth' — is, from a modern scientific standpoint, a conclusion that many see as strongly pointing toward a Creator.

NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

Ibrahim (AS)'s journey teaches us that doubt, when faced honestly, leads to stronger faith — not away from it. He did not suppress his questions. He did not inherit his belief blindly. He LOOKED, he REASONED, he TESTED — and arrived at Allah through the pure power of intellect guided by Allah's grace. If you or someone you know is struggling with doubts about faith, this passage is the Quran's answer: engage your mind fully. The One who created your intellect is not afraid of your questions.

PART 2: THE 10 COMMANDMENTS OF ISLAM — 6:151-153

The Quran's Moral Foundation — Echoing and Completing the Torah

In three consecutive verses, Allah gives what scholars call the 'Ten Commandments of Islam' — the non-negotiable moral foundations that no culture, era, or circumstance can override. Compare these with the Biblical Ten Commandments and notice the remarkable alignment — with the Quran going further on several points.

قُلْ تَعَالَوْا أَتْلُ مَا حَرَّمَ رَبُّكُمْ عَلَيْكُمْ أَلَّا تُشْرِكُوا بِهِ شَيْئًا

"Say: Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited for you: Do not associate anything with Him in worship." 6:151

#	Quranic Commandment (6:151-153)	Biblical Equivalent	Quranic Addition/Difference
1	Do not commit Shirk — associate nothing with Allah	You shall have no other gods	Qur'an extends: all false objects of worship, not just idols
2	Treat parents with Ihsan — beautiful goodness	Honour your father and mother	Qur'an adds: even if they are wrong — be good, but don't obey sin
3	Do not kill your children out of poverty	You shall not murder (general)	Specific: addressing infanticide — 'We provide for you and them'
4	Do not approach immorality — public or private	You shall not commit adultery	Qur'an extends beyond the act to approaching it — guard the path
5	Do not kill a life that Allah has made sacred	You shall not murder	Qur'an adds 'unless by right' — permits justice, not vengeance
6	Do not touch the orphan's wealth	No direct equivalent	Islam adds unique protection for the vulnerable
7	Fulfil the measure and the scale with justice	No direct equivalent	Islamic commercial ethics — be precise and fair in all dealings
8	Speak with justice even against your own kin	You shall not give false testimony	Qur'an extends: even if it harms your family — truth first
9	Fulfil the covenant of Allah	No direct equivalent	Every promise made in Allah's name is sacred



#	Quranic Commandment (6:151-153)	Biblical Equivalent	Quranic Addition/Difference
10	This is My Straight Path — follow it alone	No direct equivalent	The Quran closes with the concept of Siratal Mustaqeem

♦ MIRACLE: Same Source — Same Message Across 3,000 Years

The remarkable similarity between these Quranic commandments and the Biblical Ten Commandments — given to Prophet Musa (AS) approximately 1,400 years before the Quran — is not coincidence. The Quran explains: 'He has ordained for you the same religion (deen) which He enjoined upon Nuh, and that which We have revealed to you, and that which We enjoined upon Ibrahim, Musa, and Isa — to establish the religion and not to be divided therein.' (42:13). Same God. Same core message. Different communities. Different times. This is precisely what the Quran means by calling itself a confirmation of what came before it.

PART 3: SIGNS OF ALLAH IN CREATION — 6:95-99

The Quran as a Book of Signs (Ayat) in Nature

The Arabic word 'Ayah' means BOTH a verse of the Quran AND a sign in creation. This is deliberate. The Quran constantly directs us to look at the natural world as a second scripture — written not in Arabic but in the language of atoms, seeds, rain, and stars.

وَهُوَ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَخْرَجْنَا بِهِ نَبَاتَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ

"And it is He who sends down rain from the sky, and We produce thereby the growth of all things." 6:99

Natural Sign Mentioned	Quranic Reference	Modern Scientific Wonder
Splitting of the seed/kernel	6:95	Inside every seed is a complete genetic programme — DNA containing the blueprint of an entire organism
Emergence of living from dead	6:95	The carbon cycle: dead matter becomes food for new life — the Quran's description of ecosystems
The dawn breaking	6:96	The daily rotation of Earth, giving 24-hour cycles — precision calibrated for all life
Stars for navigation	6:97	Before GPS: the stars as the original navigation system — sailors crossed oceans by them
Rain from clouds	6:99	The water cycle: evaporation, condensation, precipitation — sustaining all land life
Gardens of varying fruits from same water	6:99	Epigenetics: same environment, different genetic expression — miraculous diversity
Grapes, olives, pomegranates	6:99	Each referenced fruit is studied for their nutritional and health benefits.

The Quran's Invitation to Scientific Observation:

Count the words of intellectual command in Al-An'am alone:

- 'Afala ta'qiloon' — Will you not reason? (mentioned 13 times in the Quran)
- 'Afala yatafakkarun' — Will you not reflect? (mentioned 4 times)
- 'Afala yubsirun' — Will you not see? (mentioned 3 times)
- 'Unzuru' — Look! Observe! (mentioned 45 times)

The Quran commands observation of reality more than any other religious text. Islam encourages reflection on creation, and many see harmony between revelation and observed reality..

PART 4: ALLAH BEYOND ALL PERCEPTION — 6:103

لَا تُدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ وَهُوَ يُدْرِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ وَهُوَ اللَّطِيفُ الْخَبِيرُ

"Vision cannot perceive Him, but He perceives all vision. He is the Subtle, the Acquainted." 6:103

This verse encapsulates one of the most profound theological truths in all of Islamic thought: Allah is beyond the grasp of created perception — yet He perceives everything. He is Al-Latif (the Subtle, the All-Aware of subtleties) and Al-Khabir (the Fully Acquainted with all things).

Attribute	Arabic	Meaning	What it teaches us
Al-Latif	اللَّطِيفُ	The Subtle — He who reaches the finest details of all things	Allah's care for you goes to the smallest, most hidden need
Al-Khabir	الْخَبِيرُ	The Fully Acquainted — He who knows the innermost reality of all things	Nothing is hidden from Him — not your secrets, not your pain
La tudrikuhu al-absar	لَا تُدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ	No vision can encompass Him	He is beyond all created frameworks — cannot be 'pictured' or contained
Wa huwa yudrikul absar	وَهُوَ يُدْرِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ	But He perceives all vision	While He transcends perception, nothing escapes His awareness

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: Can We See Allah? — The Scholarly Position

Scholars of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah are unanimous that Allah cannot be seen in this world — but the believers WILL see Allah in the Hereafter, as an honour and the greatest pleasure of Paradise. The Prophet ﷺ said: 'You will see your Lord as you see the full moon — no crowding, no difficulty.' (Bukhari). The seeing of Allah in Jannah is the summit of all spiritual reward. Verse 6:103 refers to the limitation of worldly vision — not the eternal vision granted in Paradise as a gift of divine grace. Scholars note that this is one of the clearest proofs of Allah's transcendence (Tanzih) — He is utterly beyond all created things, while also being closer to us than our jugular vein (50:16).

SURAH 7 • JUZ 8

سُورَةُ الْأَعْرَافِ

AL-A'RAF — THE HEIGHTS

The Longest Makki Surah • The Bridge Between Worlds • Prophets from Adam to Musa

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Makki — revealed in Makkah, late Makkan period**Number of Ayat:** 206 Verses — longest Makki Surah**Named After:** Al-A'raf — the Heights or the Barrier — a place between Paradise and Hell on the Day of Judgment**Unique Feature:** The most comprehensive Prophetic narrative Surah — covering Adam, Nuh, Hud, Salih, Lut, Shu'ayb, and Musa (AS)**Key Themes:** The cosmic drama of good vs evil; Shaytan's war on humanity; how nations rise and fall; the Day of Judgment**Famous Verses:** 7:172 (the Covenant of Alast), 7:179 (those who do not use hearts/eyes/ears), 7:185 (reflection on creation), 7:204 (listen when Quran is recited)**The Big Picture:** A sweeping panorama from the first human to the final Prophet ﷺ — showing one unbroken divine plan

THE ARCHITECTURE OF SURAH AL-A'RAF

Section	Verses	Content	Lesson
The Opening Warning	1-9	The Book, the weighing of deeds, accountability	Every deed will be weighed — not one atom's weight escapes
Adam, Iblees & the Fall	11-27	Creation of Adam, Shaytan's refusal, Paradise lost	The original spiritual war — still ongoing in our hearts
Children of Adam — Warning	26-53	Clothing of Taqwa; following Shaytan's footsteps	We are Adam's children — facing the same tests he faced
The A'raf — The Heights	46-53	People on the Heights between Paradise and Hell	A mysterious group — scholars debate who they are
Prophet Nuh (AS)	59-64	950 years of preaching — then the flood	Patience in dawah; destruction of those who mock
Prophet Hud (AS) & 'Aad	65-72	'Aad — a mighty civilisation — destroyed by wind	Physical power is no protection against divine wrath
Prophet Salih (AS) & Thamud	73-79	The she-camel miracle; Thamud's destruction	One miraculous test — failed through arrogance
Prophet Lut (AS)	80-84	Sodom and the inversion of human nature	Immorality brings collapse — spiritual and civilisational
Prophet Shu'ayb (AS) & Madyan	85-93	Economic corruption; dishonest weights and measures	Social justice is part of Prophethood

Section	Verses	Content	Lesson
Prophet Musa (AS) — Full Account	103-171	Confronting Pharaoh; the plagues; the Torah; the Covenant	The longest Prophetic story in the Quran — the full arc
The Covenant of Alast	172-174	Every soul witnessed Allah before birth	We all made a promise to Allah — before we were born
Those Who Waste Their Gifts	175-179	The scholar who had knowledge but followed desires	The greatest tragedy: knowing the truth and rejecting it

PART 5: THE COVENANT OF ALAST — 7:172

The Promise Every Soul Made Before Being Born

وَإِذْ أَخَذَ رَبُّكَ مِنْ بَنِي آدَمَ مِنْ ظُهُورِهِمْ ذُرِّيَّتَهُمْ وَأَشْهَدَهُمْ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ

"And when your Lord took from the children of Adam — from their loins — their descendants and made them testify of themselves: 'Am I not your Lord?' They said: 'Yes, we have testified.'" 7:172

This verse describes one of the most extraordinary events in existence — something that happened before this world, before our birth, before our memory. Allah gathered every soul that would ever be born — all of humanity from Adam (AS) to the Last Day — and asked them a question.

The Covenant of Alast — Understanding the Event:

The Question: 'Alastu bi-Rabbikum?' — 'Am I not your Lord?' Allah asked every soul directly.

The Answer: 'Bala shahidna' — 'Yes, we have testified.' Every soul — including yours — answered YES.

Why this matters: Allah says: 'Lest you say on the Day of Resurrection: We were unaware of this.' (7:172). The Covenant removes the excuse of ignorance. Deep in every human soul is an imprint of this original recognition of Allah.

The Fitrah connection: The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Every child is born on the Fitrah (natural disposition to Islam).' (Bukhari). The Covenant of Alast is the source of this Fitrah — an original, pre-birth recognition of the Divine.

For those who 'convert': Scholars note that 'reverts' — those who return to Islam — are simply remembering what their soul already knew.

♦ MIRACLE: The Deepest Layer of Human Consciousness

Psychologist Carl Jung described what he called the 'collective unconscious' — a layer of the human mind shared across all humans, containing universal archetypes and an innate sense of the sacred. He observed that across all cultures and all times, humans display an intrinsic religious impulse — a reach toward the transcendent. Neuroscientists have identified what they call the 'God spot' — neural pathways associated with spiritual experience present in all humans regardless of cultural background. The Quran's Covenant of Alast — a pre-birth, pre-memory agreement with Allah — has been compared by some writers to the innate human inclination toward belief as universal human spirituality.

📖 STORY: The Man Who Had Knowledge But Lost His Soul — 7:175-176

After describing the Covenant of Alast, Allah immediately tells a cautionary story: 'And recite to them the news of the one to whom We gave Our signs, but he detached himself from them. And Shaytan pursued him and he became of the deviants. And if We had willed, We could have elevated him thereby, but he clung to the earth and followed his own desire. So his example is like that of the dog: if you chase it, it pants, or if you leave it, it pants.' (7:175-176). This unnamed man — identified by scholars in their commentaries as Bal'am ibn Ba'ura, a scholar of Bani Israel who was given divine knowledge — chose status, money, and worldly comfort over truth. He is among the saddest figures in the Quran — not because he lacked knowledge, but because he had it and wasted it. The Quran's lesson: knowledge without action becomes a curse, not a blessing.

📌 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

The Covenant of Alast answers the question: 'Why do I sometimes feel drawn to something greater, even when I've drifted from religion?' That pull is your soul's memory of the original promise. When you feel the urge to pray, to be good, to seek Allah — that is the Fitrah speaking. When you ignore it repeatedly, it becomes quieter. Scholars teach: feed the Fitrah with Dhikr, Quran, righteous company, and it grows stronger. Starve it with sin, distraction, and heedlessness, and it weakens — like a fire without fuel.

PART 6: THE PROPHETS OF AL-A'RAF — A COMPARATIVE STUDY

Six Prophets, One Message, Different Nations

Surah Al-A'raf is unique in presenting six Prophet stories in sequence, allowing us to see the universal pattern of Prophethood. Each story follows an almost identical structure — yet each nation's response, failure, and destruction is unique.

Prophet	Nation	Their Sin	Miracle/Sign	Their Response	Consequence
Nuh (AS)	Pre-flood humanity	Idol worship after 950 years of preaching	The Ark — warned of flood	Mocked him relentlessly	Global flood — only believers survived
Hud (AS)	'Aad — in ancient Arabia	Arrogance, rejection of monotheism	No specific miracle — just the message	'Who is stronger than us?'	Destroyed by a ferocious wind for 7 nights and 8 days
Salih (AS)	Thamud — carved into mountains	Oppression and arrogance	The she-camel as a living miracle	Hamstrung the camel in defiance	Earthquake destroyed them within 3 days
Lut (AS)	Sodom (Sadum)	Sexual immorality — the inversion of natural order	Angels appeared as men to test them	Tried to harm the divine guests	Rained stones of clay — city overturned
Shu'ayb (AS)	Madyan — commercial city	Fraud, dishonest weights, economic corruption	No physical miracle — moral argument	'Your prayer tells you to stop our trade?'	Earthquake or thunder — scholars differ
Musa (AS)	Egypt — Pharaoh's kingdom	Tyranny, claiming divinity, enslaving Bani Israel	9 miracles including the staff, sea parting	Pharaoh hardened his heart every time	Drowned in the sea — army annihilated

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Universal Pattern of Prophethood

Every Prophet story in Al-A'raf follows the same divine template — what scholars call the 'Sunnah of Allah in history.' The pattern: (1) A Prophet is sent to a people lost in sin; (2) He calls them to Tawheed and justice; (3) The elite resist — because Prophethood threatens their power; (4) The masses either follow or mock; (5) The believers are saved; (6) The rejectors are destroyed. This pattern repeats across 124,000 Prophets (according to Hadith). The consistency is not coincidence — it is Allah's way (Sunnat-Allah) in dealing with human communities. The Quran presents these stories not as ancient history but as a mirror: 'So relate the stories — perhaps they will reflect.' (7:176)

PROPHET'S STORY: Sayyiduna Nuh (AS) — 950 Years of Dawah

Nuh (Noah) alayhis salam preached to his people for 950 years — the longest sustained mission of any Prophet. Not 950 converts — 950 years of mostly rejection. He tried every method: public preaching, private counselling, day and night, in groups and alone (71:5-9). He built the Ark under divine command while being mocked as a madman by his people. His own son refused to board — and drowned. When the flood came, the water covered even the highest mountains. Only those on the Ark survived. When the waters receded, the Ark rested on Mount Judi (modern Cudi Dagi in Turkey — where expeditions have found intriguing anomalies on the summit). The lesson of Nuh (AS): results are Allah's business. Our job is to convey the message with patience, for as long as we live. SubhanAllah — 950 years.

✿ **PROPHET'S STORY: Sayyiduna Musa (AS) vs Pharaoh — The Greatest Political Confrontation in History**

The Musa-Pharaoh confrontation in Al-A'raf (verses 103-155) is the Quran's longest and most detailed Prophetic account. A stuttering shepherd-prophet walks into the most powerful court on earth and says: 'Let my people go.' Pharaoh — who claimed divinity — responded with magicians, imprisonment threats, and mockery. Allah sent nine miracles (plagues): the staff turning to a serpent, a luminous hand, floods, locusts, lice, frogs, blood in the water, darkness, and the death of the firstborn. Each time, Pharaoh agreed — then hardened his heart. The Quran uses the phrase 'We hardened his heart' — which scholars explain as Allah allowing the consequences of Pharaoh's own freely chosen stubbornness to set in. The final miracle — the parting of the sea — destroyed the greatest army of the ancient world. The Quran's lesson: no system of human oppression lasts forever. Every Pharaoh has a sea waiting for him.

PART 7: AL-A'RAF — THE HEIGHTS BETWEEN PARADISE AND HELL (7:46-49)

One of the Most Mysterious Passages in the Quran

The Surah takes its name from a remarkable scene on the Day of Judgment: a place called Al-A'raf — the Heights or the Ramparts — a barrier between Paradise and Hell, occupied by a group of people who can see both.

وَبَيْنَهُمَا حِجَابٌ وَعَلَى الْأَعْرَافِ رِجَالٌ يَّعْرِفُونَ كُلًّا بِسِيمَاهُمْ

"And between them is a veil, and on the Heights are men who recognise everyone by their marks."

7:46

Who Are the People of Al-A'raf? — Scholarly Views:

View 1 (Imam Ibn Abbas □ and majority): People whose good and bad deeds are exactly equal — they await Allah's mercy to enter Paradise.

View 2 (Some scholars): Great Islamic scholars and martyrs who have a special vantage point — they see the whole panorama of Judgment Day.

View 3: Those who died without clearly receiving the message — not guilty of rejection, not fully guided.

The ending: The Quran does not resolve their fate in the Surah — but scholars note that 7:49 implies they eventually enter Paradise by Allah's mercy: 'Enter Paradise — no fear upon you, nor shall you grieve.'

The existence of Al-A'raf shows us that Allah's judgment is infinitely more nuanced than our human categories of 'saved' or 'condemned.' Every soul is judged with complete knowledge of every circumstance.

PART 8: THE GREATEST CONDEMNATION OF HEEDLESSNESS — 7:179

وَلَقَدْ ذَرَأْنَا لِجَهَنَّمَ كَثِيرًا مِّنَ الْجِنِّ وَالْإِنسِ لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ بِهَا

"And We have certainly created for Hell many of the jinn and mankind. They have hearts with which they do not understand, eyes with which they do not see, and ears with which they do not hear. They are like livestock — in fact, they are more astray. They are the heedless." 7:179

This verse is one of the most confronting in the Quran — and one of the most important for our age of information overload, digital distraction, and spiritual numbness.

Faculty Given by Allah	When It's Wasted	When It's Used
Qalb (Heart — centre of understanding)	Watching/consuming content that hardens the heart; sins that seal it	Dhikr, Quran recitation, sitting with the righteous — these polish it
Absar (Eyes — sight)	Looking at the haram; scrolling endlessly without reflection	Looking at creation as a sign of Allah; seeing the Quran's words
Adhan (Ears — hearing)	Listening to music that deadens the soul; gossip; backbiting	Listening to Quran, to knowledge, to the call of the Adhan
'Aql (Intellect — reasoning)	Used only for dunya: money, status, entertainment	Directed to understand Allah, the Quran, one's purpose

⚠ WARNING: More Lost Than Cattle

The Quran says those who waste their faculties are 'like livestock — in fact, more astray.' This is one of the harshest statements in the Quran. Why more astray than cattle? Because cattle have no choice — they follow their instincts as programmed. But a human who has been given intellect, conscience, and divine guidance — and still chooses heedlessness — has wilfully rejected a gift that the entire creation was not given. The heart that has heard the Quran and felt nothing, seen the universe and felt no wonder, heard the Adhan and felt no pull — this is the spiritual emergency the verse diagnoses.

📖 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

7:179 is also a map to spiritual revival. If your heart feels hard — return to Quran recitation with meaning. If your eyes feel blind to signs — go outside and look at the sky, the trees, the stars. If your ears feel deaf — sit in a gathering of Dhikr, a Quran recitation, or simply listen to the Adhan with full attention. These are not metaphors — they are spiritual prescriptions. The heart is like a mirror: sin clouds it, repentance and worship polishes it back to clarity.

PART 9: HOW TO LISTEN TO THE QURAN — 7:204

وَإِذَا قُرِئَ الْقُرْآنُ فَاسْتَمِعُوا لَهُ وَأَنْصِتُوا لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ

"And when the Quran is recited, listen to it attentively and be silent, that you may receive mercy." 7:204

This single verse contains the complete etiquette (Adab) of engaging with the Quran when it is being recited aloud. It reveals something profound: the Quran is not background noise. It is the living speech of Allah — and it demands our full, conscious presence.

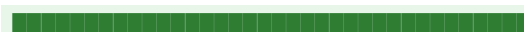
The Two Commands of 7:204:

1. Istami'u — LISTEN ATTENTIVELY: Not merely hearing (sama') but deep, intentional listening. Direct your ears, your mind, and your heart toward what is being recited. Know that Allah is speaking.

2. Ansitu — BE SILENT: Stop talking. Stop moving unnecessarily. The Quran's recitation is a moment of divine address — respond with the silence of reverence, not the noise of distraction.

The Promise: 'La'allakum turhamun' — 'So that you may receive mercy.' Mercy (Rahmah) descends when the Quran is recited and listened to with presence. This is why scholars say that gatherings of Quran recitation are showered with angels and mercy.

The Five Levels of Engaging with the Quran

Level 1: Hearing (Sami'a)	 1	Quran in background — least beneficial
Level 2: Listening (Istima')	 3	Directing ears attentively
Level 3: Reflection (Tadabbur)	 6	Pondering meanings — recommended
Level 4: Understanding (Tafaqquh)	 8	Learning with tafsir
Level 5: Acting (Amal + Tabligh)	 10	Living and sharing it — highest level



SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Gathering of Quran — Angels Descend

The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Any group of people that assemble in one of the Houses of Allah to recite the Book of Allah, learning and teaching it — tranquillity (Sakinah) descends upon them, mercy envelops them, and angels surround them, and Allah mentions them to those in His presence.' (Muslim). The Quran Khwani, the Khatm, the Dars, the Halaqah — these are not mere customs. They are the practical application of 7:204, and each gathering draws down the Rahmah of Allah.

JUZ 6 & 7 — KEY LESSONS SUMMARY

Major Themes in Juz 6 & 7 (Proportion of Content)

Proofs of Tawheed	50	Al-An'am
Ibrahim's search for God	20	Al-An'am 6:75-79
10 Islamic Commandments	15	Al-An'am 6:151-153
Signs in Nature	30	Al-An'am 6:95-99
Prophet Stories (x6)	70	Al-A'raf
Covenant of Alast	10	Al-A'raf 7:172
The A'raf (Heights)	10	Al-A'raf 7:46-49
Warning on Heedlessness	12	Al-A'raf 7:179
Adab of Quran	8	Al-A'raf 7:204

Golden Lesson	Surah & Verse	One-Line Summary
Doubt + honest reasoning leads to God	Al-An'am 6:75-79	Ibrahim (AS) used his mind — so can you
Creation is full of signs of Allah	Al-An'am 6:95-99	Every seed, star, and raindrop is an Ayah
Islam's 10 Commandments are universal	Al-An'am 6:151-153	The same moral core runs through all divine religions
Allah is beyond all perception	Al-An'am 6:103	He sees all — nothing escapes Him
Every soul made a covenant with Allah	Al-A'raf 7:172	Your Fitrah is a memory of that promise
Knowledge without action is the greatest waste	Al-A'raf 7:175-176	The scholar who became like a dog
Six Prophets — one pattern of truth	Al-A'raf throughout	Every nation received warning — no excuse
Unused faculties = spiritual death	Al-A'raf 7:179	Use your heart, eyes, and ears for Allah
Listen to the Quran with full presence	Al-A'raf 7:204	Silence + attention = mercy descends

Reflection Questions — Juz 6 & 7

Question	Verse	Action This Week
Have I ever rationally examined WHY I believe?	6:75-79	Spend 10 minutes thinking about the signs of Allah in your own life



Question	Verse	Action This Week
Do I see the natural world as signs of Allah?	6:95-99	Go outside. Name three things you see as Ayat of Allah.
Which of the 10 Commandments do I struggle with most?	6:151-153	Identify one. Make a commitment to strengthen it.
Do I feel the pull of my Fitrah? When?	7:172	Notice the moments when your soul reaches for Allah
Am I using my heart, eyes, and ears for Allah?	7:179	Audit: what did you listen to, watch, and feel today?
How do I behave when the Quran is being recited?	7:204	From today: full silence and attention when Quran is being read



رَبَّنَا ظَلَمْنَا أَنْفُسَنَا وَإِنْ لَّمْ تَغْفِرْ لَنَا وَتَرْحَمْنَا لَنَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْخَسِرِينَ

'Our Lord, we have wronged ourselves. If You do not forgive us and have mercy on us, we shall be among the losers.'

— Du'a of Adam and Hawwa (AS) (Al-A'raf 7:23)

Volume V — Juz 8, 9 & 10: Surah Al-Anfal, At-Tawbah & Yunus

Battle of Badr • Hypocrites Exposed • Prophet Yunus in the Whale • Mercy for All

Compiled with love for the Ummah of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ
In the blessed tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Sallallahu alayhi wa aalihi wa sahbihi wa sallam